

Game Design

a system that generates designed PLAY

what are they made of?

- Players
- Actions
- Rules
- Objects
- Goals

In a playspace

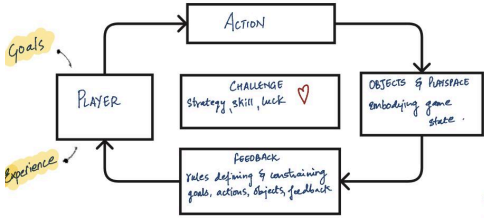
Producing → CHALLENGES

★ **FEEDBACK**
on action effects
↓
Evokes
Experience!

GAME DESIGNERS

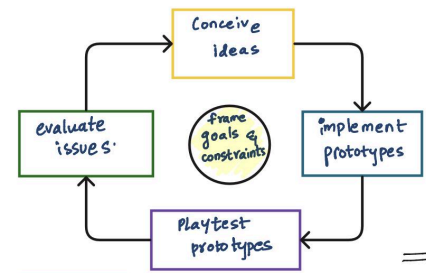
↳ create systems that affords these

Basic Feedback Loop ⇒
(gameplay)



WHAT MAKES GD DIFFERENT?
 → **SECOND ORDER DESIGN**
 make system within which
 players make their "actual"
 play experience.
 → **POSSIBILITY SPACE**
 range of possible act/cor
 gund states w/in given sys.

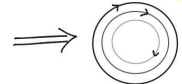
BUT, **How** do Game Designers do that?
Iterative GD Process



★ What do/don't we try to accomplish?
 ★ How might we Accomplish that?
 ★ A prototype asks: Will this work?
 ★ Playtest → Answers → Did this work?
 ★ What was the answer? What's the next question?

ITERATIVE PROCESS

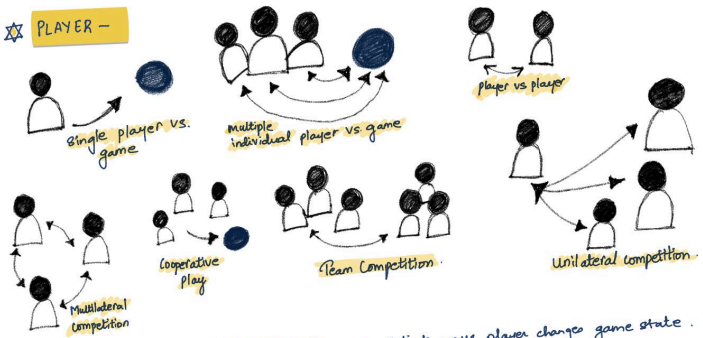
aka
PLAY-CENTRIC DESIGN



Reasons to iterate?
 → Second order design → its an experience to be played, can't be calculated ⇒ **PLAY IT!**
 ↳ De-risking → to make sure the game is "Fun".
Formal Building Block
 (of games)

Mechanics ⇒ Broad, Narrow.
 ↳ goals ↳ verb
 ↳ levels ↳ turn order
Elements

★ **PLAYER --**



★ **ACTION --**

or is it **VERB** ⊕ → distinct ways player changes game state.

GAME EXPERIENCE → **FUN** → Pleasure & surprises

WHAT'S

a good game --
 → different people value different experiences.

- CHOICES
- GOALS
- DURATION
- PACE
- AGENCY
- FAIRNESS



Unfold game over time ⊕

Narrative, Arcs Difficulty Game objects Thematic worlds Novelty

